

Business Requirement Document (BRD): Internship Progress Dashboard

Executive Summary

This Business Requirement Document (BRD) outlines the need and proposed solution for the **Internship Progress Dashboard** project. The project is a web-based platform designed to centralize and optimize the management of remote internships.

Business Need

The organization requires a structured, centralized, and transparent system to efficiently manage remote interns, replacing the current manual, fragmented processes. This system is crucial for scaling the remote internship program while maintaining quality control and ensuring every intern receives adequate guidance.

Expected Outcome

The successful implementation of this dashboard is expected to lead to:

- Improved visibility into intern performance and project progress.
- Increased intern accountability and productivity.
- Standardized and efficient workflow for mentors and admins.

Business Objectives

The primary objectives of the Internship Progress Dashboard are:

- **Improve Internship Tracking:** Provide a standardized, real-time method for tracking all intern activities and deliverables.
- **Increase Productivity and Accountability:** Clearly define tasks, deadlines, and ownership to boost the output and sense of responsibility for interns.
- **Centralized Monitoring System:** Consolidate all intern-related data (tasks, progress, reports, and feedback) into one secure platform.
- **Enhance Mentor-Intern Communication:** Facilitate structured and efficient interactions regarding task progress and performance feedback.

Problem Statement

The current system for managing remote internships presents several challenges that hinder efficiency and organizational oversight:

- **No Centralized System:** Tracking is scattered across various tools (email, spreadsheets, disparate chat applications), leading to data silos and loss of critical information.
- **Manual Tracking Issues:** Manual updating of progress is time-consuming, prone to errors, and lacks real-time accuracy, consuming valuable mentor time.
- **Lack of Visibility into Intern Performance:** Decision-makers and mentors struggle to get a quick, accurate overview of individual intern performance or overall program status.
- **Inefficient Communication:** Feedback loops are often slow and unstructured, delaying necessary course corrections and reducing the quality of the internship experience.

Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is the development of the **Internship Progress Dashboard**, a comprehensive web platform that provides the following key features:

- **Dashboard-Based System:** A personalized landing page for each user role (Intern, Mentor, Admin) providing relevant, actionable data at a glance.
- **Task Management (Kanban):** A visual system, similar to a Kanban board, for mentors to assign tasks and for interns to update task status (To Do, In Progress, Complete).
- **Progress Tracking (Analytics):** Automated visualization tools (charts and graphs) that convert task data into easy-to-understand progress insights for mentors.
- **Report Submission + Feedback System:** A dedicated module for interns to submit weekly or final reports and for mentors to deliver structured, recorded performance feedback.

Stakeholders & User Roles

This project impacts three primary stakeholder groups:

Stakeholder Role	Primary Responsibilities
Intern	Manage assigned tasks; Track personal progress; Submit reports and documentation.
Mentor/Admin	Assign tasks and set deadlines; Monitor intern progress and performance; Provide timely and recorded feedback.

Stakeholder Role	Primary Responsibilities
Organization/Company	Oversee the entire internship program; Gain strategic insights from aggregated data; Ensure program goals are met.

Scope of the Project

The scope defines the boundaries of the initial project implementation:

In Scope

- **Task Management:** Creation, assignment, status updates, and deadline tracking for individual tasks.
- **Progress Tracking:** Visualization of task completion rates and time spent on tasks.
- **User Authentication:** Secure login and role-based access control for all three user types.
- **Dashboard:** High-level summary view tailored to the needs of the Intern and Mentor/Admin roles.
- **Report Submission & Feedback:** Ability for interns to upload documents and for mentors to enter structured feedback.

Out of Scope

- **Payment Systems:** Integration with payroll or stipend processing systems.
- **External Integrations:** Direct links or data exchange with existing HRIS or external tools like communication platforms (e.g., Slack, email).

Business Requirements

Functional (Business-Level) Requirements

These describe what the system must do to support business operations:

- **Users can track tasks:** The system must allow interns to clearly see all assigned tasks, deadlines, and current status.
- **Mentors can monitor performance:** The system must provide mentors with a clear, aggregated view of all their assigned interns' task progress and completion history.
- **System provides progress insights:** The system must generate visual data representations (charts) summarizing overall internship completion rates for the Admin role.

Non-Functional Requirements

These describe how well the system must perform:

- **Fast Performance:** The platform must load pages and process data within acceptable time limits (e.g., under 3 seconds) to ensure a smooth user experience.
- **Secure System:** User data, task information, and performance reports must be protected using industry-standard security protocols.
- **Easy Usability:** The user interface (UI) must be intuitive and easy to navigate for non-technical interns and mentors.



Success Metrics (KPIs)

The following Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) will be used to measure the success and business value of the new dashboard:

- **Task Completion Rate:** The percentage of assigned tasks completed by interns on or before the deadline (Target: >85%).
- **User Engagement:** The average frequency of logins per week by both Interns and Mentors, indicating active adoption of the platform (Target: At least 3 logins/week).
- **System Usage Frequency:** The volume of reports submitted and feedback records created within the system per week, indicating the centralized process is being followed.



Risks & Assumptions

Risks

- **Low User Adoption:** Interns or Mentors may resist changing from manual processes, leading to data inaccuracy. This will be mitigated through mandatory training and clear communication of benefits.
- **Technical Issues:** Unexpected bugs or integration problems could delay the rollout. This will be mitigated by thorough testing and a phased rollout plan.

Assumptions

- **Users have internet access:** All interns and mentors have reliable access to the internet to use the web-based platform.
- **Basic technical knowledge:** All users possess the basic skills required to navigate a web application and input data.
- All required stakeholders, including , are available for reviews and sign-offs on the system design by .



Business Rules

The following rules govern the operation and data within the system:

- **One mentor manages multiple interns:** The system must support a 1-to-N relationship between Mentors and Interns.
- **Tasks must have deadlines:** Every task created within the system must be assigned a mandatory due date.
- **Progress must be updated regularly:** Interns are required to update the status of 'In Progress' tasks at least once every 48 hours.



Workflow Overview

This is the standard workflow managed by the dashboard:

1. **Mentor assigns task:** A Mentor creates a new task within the platform and assigns it to an Intern, setting a deadline.
2. **Intern works & updates:** The Intern accepts the task, changes the status to 'In Progress,' and updates the status as they work.
3. **Intern submits report:** Upon completion of a milestone or at a scheduled interval, the Intern submits a report document via the system.
4. **Mentor gives feedback:** The Mentor reviews the report and task progress, providing structured feedback directly within the system.

A visual guide to this process is available in the appendix [File](#).



Future Scope

The following features are considered out of the initial scope but are planned for a later phase:

- **AI-based Recommendations:** Implementing AI to suggest relevant learning resources or flag tasks at risk of delay.
- **Real-Time Chat:** Integrating a direct, real-time chat function between the Intern and Mentor within the platform.
- **Notifications System:** Implementing automated email and in-platform notifications for approaching deadlines and new feedback.
- **External learning resource integration:** Connecting the dashboard with popular educational platforms to assign courses related to tasks.